Ghestem

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In bridge, Ghestem is a conventional two-suited overcall that shows at least 5-5 distribution. The convention is named for its inventor, the late Pierre Ghestem of France. The overcalls differ if the opponents opened 1♣ vs. any other 1-level bid.

Over 1♣, the conventional overcalls are as follows.

Overcall	Meaning
2♦	At least 5-5 in ♥ and ♠
2NT	At least 5-5 in ♦ and ♥
3♣	At least 5-5 in ♦ and ♠

Over any other one-level opening:

Overcall	Meaning
2NT	At least 5-5 in the two lowest-ranking suits
3♣	At least 5-5 in the two highest-ranking suits
Cuebid	At least 5-5 in the top and bottom suits

Point strength needed for Ghestem depends on partnership agreement. Here are three possible approaches:

- Constructive, showing 12+ points
- Any strength, 0+ points
- Weak (0-10 points) or strong (16+ points). With an intermediate hand of 11-15 points, begin with a simple overcall and bid your second suit later.

Ghestem vs. Michaels

Compared to the Michaels cuebid, Ghestem always specifies exactly two suits. A Michaels major-suit cuebid, on the other hand, shows the other major and an unspecified minor.

But Ghestem has its own drawbacks. The 3♣ jump overcall loses its weak preemptive meaning and also forces the bidding up to the 3-level. Compare this to Michaels, in which a 2-level minor-suit cuebid lets the overcaller compete at the 2-level.

See also

- Colorful Cue Bid
  An older, conventional cuebid to show a two-suited hand based on suit color.